

An often-maligned figure, former ARVN general Nguyen Van Thieu served as the president of South Vietnam until 1975. He was the last South Vietnamese president to govern for a substantial period of time—his successor, Duong Van Minh, was president for just two days before Saigon fell to North Vietnamese forces. Thieu was criticized during his presidency for his authoritarian style, and for his perceived intransigence, which Nixon and Kissinger blamed for stalling the peace negotiations in 1972. Thieu, on the other hand, felt betrayed and abandoned by the United States, and publicly expressed great anger toward his American allies in the final years of his presidency.